



RSS Ticker, if you're looking at aggregating your desired content

and organiser functions to the browser. Since the browser is one of the most used applications on a computer, setting reminders on your browser is the most effective way of maintaining your To-Do list. Reminder Fox integrates with ease into Firefox and gives the user the power to manage To Do lists, set reminders, notification alerts and alarms right from their browser.

RSS Ticker

RSS is a very good source of information and is a common communication standard for many blogs and news sites. The RSS Ticker add-on in Firefox shows all the live bookmarks in a scrolling fashion across the user's screen and the updates are visible to the user while browsing itself. So the user doesn't have to specifically log in to any feed reader like Google Reader for accessing the RSS feeds of their choice.

Scrapbook Plus

Scrapbook Plus is a great Firefox add-on for people who want to organise their web pages or even full web sites. The add-on lets you define filters which can be defined to exclude related links or any unwanted web pages. It is way better than making a list of cluttered bookmarks and not knowing what the bookmark is about at a later date.

Grease Monkey

Greasemonkey is one the oldest and the most popular add-ons used in Firefox which is primarily employed to run custom scripts on web pages. It changes the way a web page works or is displayed and how it interacts with a customer using small bits of JavaScript. You can write your own custom code to make changes to how your browser interacts with a particular web site and automate many manual processes and get more done faster.

Gimp

GIMP which is short for the GNU (which is recursively short for 'GNU is Not Unix') Image Manipulation Program is an open source and free alternative to Photoshop, available for Windows and Linux platform. We will now mention some handy tips and new tricks for the same.

Convert to black and white

Go To Colors, and Select Desaturate. You will be now presented with three options 'Lightness', 'Luminosity' or 'Average', ignore the technicalities and choose what pleases your eye. If you want more control over this, select 'Hue-Saturation', Click on Master, and drag the 'Saturation' slider till you achieve your desired effect.

Installing plug-ins and scripts

You can download as many plugins or scripts you want from <http://registry.gimp.org/> among many other places to enhance your functionality. Now from the Menu, go to 'Edit > Preferences > Folders', from there note down the location of the 'Plug-ins' and 'Scripts' folder. Then simply copy the Plug-ins or scripts you have just downloaded from the Internet there and restart GIMP.

Linux users are strongly recommended to install the 'gimp-plugin-registry' package. On a Debian-based system such as Ubuntu, this can be done by typing `Sudo apt-get install gimp-plugin-registry` on the terminal.

Rounded Corners

If you think photos look fancy with rounded corners, here is how you do it. Choose "Rounded Rectangle" from 'Select' Menu, Choose a Radius of around 30%, then press [Ctrl] + [I] to invert the selection (optionally you can choose invert from select menu) and now simply press 'Delete' button. If whitespace around images trouble you, go to **Image>Autocrop Image** and you are done.

Open a closed toolBox

Many new users get frustrated when they can't figure out how to open the layers toolbox or any other toolbox after closing it by mistake, since Gimp provides separate windows for each. Solution is very simple, Just go to 'Windows>Recently Closed Docks' and select what you want to reopen. Under **Windows > Dockable Dialogs** you will find all the toolboxes.

Finding a plug-in

After installing a plug-in/script you might find yourself digging through the menus in hope to find it. A smarter way is to go "Help > Plug-in Browser" and then search for your plug-in. Then the third-line in the right hand side pane, will show you the Menu Hierarchy under which it is located.

Liquid Rescaling

Have you ever wanted to resize a picture with a change in aspect ratio, hoping it won't distort important things inside, like in a very very smart way. This is your answer to that. It uses a very innovative 'Seam Carving' algorithm. Install the plugin from registry.gimp.org [If you have gimp-plugin-registry installed it will be there by default]. You can find the plug-in under the 'Layers' menu unlike most other plug-ins which are under Filters menu. You will need to experiment a bit, but we will show you some examples, which will make your efforts worth it. For more, visit <http://liquidrescale.wikidot.com>.

Processors Cores

Did you know Gimp can very effectively use multiple processing cores? If you Batch Process images or apply multiple filters at the same time, this can considerably decrease your processing time. With multiple cores being common even in laptops, it is an essential setting for speed gain. Go to 'Edit > Preferences > Processors to Use' and set it to number suited to your needs and Hardware.

Keyboard Ninja

A lot of filters will just work on the selected area of the image if there is any, and it can get difficult to remove a selection once done. In that case, simply go to the 'Select' Menu and choose 'None' or press [Shift] + [Ctrl] + [A].